Lesson 29 material: Pronunciation: Connected Speech

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 3: Zero Waste

3.6: Connected Speech

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Original page, with audio and online exercises:
https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/Book%3A_Speaking_Listening_and_Pronunciation_Projects_for_ELLs_-_Intermediate_Level_(Zemlick)/03%3A_Zero_Waste/3.06%3A_Connected_Speech
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Audio for this section is saved on your computer in `E:\personal-tutor\materials\library\esl-b1-speaking\attachments\03.06-connected-speech`: Changing t to d; Linking Consonant to Consonant ; Linking Practice; Listening - Sentences from Unit 2; Listening Practice - Linking Consonant to Consonant ; Listening Practice d = y

In this section, you will learn about four rules of connected speech. You have already seen some of these rules in previous units, so some of this information may be review.

Linking: Final Consonant to Beginning Vowel

Rules to Remember

Rules to Remember: Linking Final Consonant to Beginning Vowel

When a word with a final consonant is followed by a word beginning with a vowel, link the consonant to the vowel in the next word. Why?

- The final consonant will be easier to say.
- Your speech will sound more natural.
- This will improve your listening skills because you will start to hear when native speakers link consonants to vowels.

Examples:

- them all ------> thə-mall
- an apple -----> a-napple
- walk away ----> wal-kəway

Listening Practice

Listen to these sentences from the interview with Andy in Unit 2. Pay attention to the words in bold. Notice that the final consonant attaches to the beginning vowel of the next word. The pronunciation of the words in bold is written to the right of each sentence. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Listening - Sentences from Unit 2")

1. I'd like to ask you some **questions if** that's ok? = question -sif
2. Tell me a little **bit about** yourself. = bi-təbout
3. I **live in** San Diego. =li-vin
4. I have a younger brother **and an** older sister. =an-dən
5. I work **outside on** the farming plots. =outsi-don
6. What do you **like about** your job? =li-kəbout

Linking Practice

Listen to the short conversations. Draw a link from the underlined sounds to the vowel in the next word. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Linking Practice")

1. a. Where do you live? b. I li<u>v</u>e in San Diego.
2. a. What do you li<u>k</u>e about your job? b. I like working outsi<u>d</u>e in the sun.
3. a. Do you ha<u>v</u>e any pets? b. I don't ow<u>n</u> a pet.
4. a. Do you like to ge<u>t</u> u<u>p</u> early? b. No, I prefer to stay up late.
5. a. Do you eat meat? b. No, I avoi<u>d</u> eating meat.

Recording: Linking Final Consonant to Beginning Vowel

Practice the conversations above with a partner. When you're ready, record yourself reading each of the conversations. Remember to link the final consonant vowel to the next word.

Linking: Final Consonant to the Same Consonant

Rules to Remember

Rules to Remember: Linking Consonant to Consonant

When a word that ends with a consonant sound is followed by the same (or similar) consonant sound in the next word, you only say that sound once. Look at the examples below.

Examples:

- bla~~ck~~ coffee ----> blakoffee
- o~~ne~~ night ----> wonight
- weathe~~r~~ report ----> weatherɔport

Listening Practice

Listen and repeat the phrases in the box below. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Listening Practice - Linking Consonant to Consonant")

Listen and repeat the phrases.

black coffee some more need to good day

bus stop sit down book club gas station

Complete the sentences using the phrases from above.

1. Thanks for coming. Have a _____.
2. I'm going to a _____ meeting today. I love reading.
3. I'm going to stop at the _____ before I go to work.
4. I _____ go to the store.
5. I like to drink my coffee with milk, but my husband prefers _____.
6. Can I have _____ cake please? It's so good!
7. Please _____ The show will begin soon.
8. The bus was very late. We had to wait at the _____ all morning.

Recording: Linking Consonant to Consonant

Listen to each of the sentences and repeat them with a partner. When you're ready, make a recording of yourself reading the sentences. Remember to link the phrases that end and begin with the same consonant sound. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Linking Consonant to Consonant")

Review: Linking Final Consonant to Beginning Vowel & Final Consonant to Same Consonant

Watch the Video: Connected Speech and Linking - Elemental English

Video: https://youtu.be/gAHUTKm_1n0

Answer the Questions

After you watch the video, answer the questions below. Choose True or False.

1. The goal of learning English pronunciation is to sound exactly like a native English speaker.
   - True
   - False
2. The goal of learning English pronunciation is to understand other English speakers, and to be easily understood.
   - True
   - False
3. English is sometimes difficult to understand because Americans speak fast.
   - True
   - False
4. English is sometimes difficult to understand because Americans connect words and change sounds when they speak.
   - True
   - False
5. English speakers use connected speech because they want to make themselves difficult to understand.
   - True
   - False

6. English speakers use connected speech because it allows them to speak efficiently and with rhythm.
   - True
   - False
7. When we speak, we connect the final consonant of a word to the vowel of the next word. For example: “drop it” sounds like “dro-pit.”
   - True
   - False
8. When the final consonant sound of a word and the beginning consonant sound of the next word are the same, you only say that sound one time. Example: “book club” sounds like “booklub.”
   - True
   - False

Check your Answers

EXERCISE

1. The goal of learning English pronunciation is to sound exactly like a native English speaker.
a) True b) False

2. The goal of learning English pronunciation is to understand other English speakers, and to be easily understood.
a) True b) False

3. English is sometimes difficult to understand because Americans speak fast.
a) True b) False

4. English is sometimes difficult to understand because Americans connect words and change sounds when they speak. (True / False)

5. English speakers use connected speech because they want to make themselves difficult to understand. (True / False)

6. English speakers use connected speech because it allows them to speak efficiently and with rhythm. (True / False)

7. When we speak, we connect the final consonant of a word to the vowel of the next word. For example: “drop it” sounds like “dro-pit.” (True / False)

8. When the final consonant sound of a word and the beginning consonant sound of the next word are the same, you only say that sound one time. Example: “book club” sounds like “booklub." (True / False)

Linking and Sound Change: /t/ = /d/

Rules to Remember

Rules to Remember: Linking and Sound Change /t/ = /d//

When the /t/ sound comes between two vowels, it sounds like a quick /d/.

Examples:

- matter ----> madder
- a lot of ----> ələddə

Listening Practice: Changing /t/ to /d/

Listen to the conversations. Write the missing words on the line to complete each sentence. Each word or phrase has a /t/ sound between two vowels, so it sounds like a /d/. Remember to spell the words and phrases correctly. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Changing t to d")

EXERCISE

Fill in the missing words. Write one word in each space.

1. Q: I’m going to a _____ on _____. Do you want to come? A: No, thanks. I have _____ _____ _____ homework to do.

2. Q: _____ _____ you doing? A: I’m _____ a _____ to my aunt. She doesn’t use email.

3. Q: Would you like _____ on your toast or just jam? A: Just a _____ _____, please.

4. Q: Did you meet the new boss? A: No, I’m _____ her this afternoon.

5. Q: Would you like _____ or soda to drink? A: Just a _____ _____, please, but with _____ _____ _____ ice.

6. Q: Could you get the door please? A: _____ _____ minute.

Recording: Changing /t/ to /d/

Practice the conversations with a partner. When you're ready, record yourself reading each of the conversations. Remember to change the /t/ sound to a /d/ sound when the /t/ sound is between two vowels.

1. a. I'm going to a party and Saturday. Do you want to come? b. No, thanks. I have a lot of homework to do.
2. a. What are you doing? b. I'm writing a letter to my aunt. She doesn't use email.
3. a. Would you like butter on your toast or just jam? b. Just a little butter, please.
4. a. Did you meet the new boss? b. No, I'm meeting her this afternoon.
5. a. Would you like water or soda to drink? b. Just a water bottle, please, but with a lot of ice.
6. a. Could you get the door please? b. Wait a minute.

Linking and Sound Change: Final /d/ + /y/

Rules to Remember

Rules to Remember: Linking and Sound Change Final /d/ + /y/

When the /d/ sound (as in "did") comes before the /j/ sound (as in "you"), it becomes a /ʤ/ sound (as in "juice.")

Examples:

- did you ----> didʒə
- read you ----> readʒər

Watch the Video: Transforming d + y in English Pronunciation - Elemental English

Video: https://youtu.be/0rhfmtFrOWk

Listening Practice: d + y

Listen. Complete the sentences with the missing words. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Listening Practice d + y")

EXERCISE

Fill in the missing words

1. _____ _____ you grow up?
2. _____ _____ help me please?
3. _____ _____ go?
4. _____ _____ close the window?
5. They _____ _____ yesterday.
6. _____ _____ hear what I said?
7. _____ _____ like tea or coffee?

Recording: Connected Speech

Practice the questions with a partner. When you're ready, record yourself reading each of the questions. Remember to change the d + y to a /ʤ/ sound.

1. Where did you grow up?
2. Would you help me please?
3. Did you go?
4. Could you close the window?
5. They called you yesterday.
6. Did you hear what I said?
7. Would you like tea or coffee?